Colorado Department of Education AI Web Page (AI-Competent Profiles): Data and Student Privacy Passages

Excerpted verbatim from *Artificial Intelligence (AI) (Colorado Department of Education web page, including the Profiles of an AI-Competent Student, Educator, Administrator and Special Service Provider, the Examples in Practice, and the Glossary of Terms)*. The source has no page numbers; locations are given by section. This is a web page with several tabbed sections, not a paginated document. Ellipses (…) mark omitted text. Passing mentions are labelled "(excerpt)".

AI-Competent Student Profile: Human-Centered Learning, Social and Environmental Awareness (excerpt)

Source: web page, Profile of an AI-Competent Student

Students' understanding of AI includes its broader effects on individuals, communities, the workforce, and the environment. They are attentive to the implications of data collection, energy and resource use, automation, and unequal access to technology.

AI-Competent Student Profile: Tool Judgment (excerpt)

Source: web page, Profile of an AI-Competent Student

Students understand that different tools serve different purposes. Their choices reflect the learning goal, the capabilities and limitations of the technology, expectations for its use, and considerations of privacy, safety, and appropriateness.

AI-Competent Student Profile: Privacy, Safety, and Fairness

Source: web page, Profile of an AI-Competent Student

Students consider the rights, dignity, and well-being of others when using AI. Their choices reflect awareness of personal and sensitive information, consent, intellectual property, attribution, digital footprints, fairness, and the broader consequences of AI-assisted content, actions, and decisions.

AI-Competent Educator Profile: Tool Selection and Appropriate Use (excerpt)

Source: web page, Profile of an AI-Competent Educator

Educators select tools based on the learning goal, student age and developmental readiness, accessibility, privacy and security protections, approved uses, and the tool’s capabilities and limitations.

AI-Competent Educator Profile: Ethical Stewardship

Source: web page, Profile of an AI-Competent Educator

Educators use AI transparently and protect personally identifiable, confidential, and sensitive information. Their practice reflects requirements related to privacy, security, consent, copyright, licensing, attribution, and ownership, as well as consideration of AI’s effects on fairness, access, student identity, communities, human labor, and the environment.

AI-Competent Administrator Profile: Ethical Governance and Data Stewardship

Source: web page, Profile of an AI-Competent Administrator

An AI-competent administrator establishes safeguards that protect privacy, clarify expectations, and maintain accountability for how AI is selected and used.

Privacy and Data Stewardship: Administrators protect student and staff information by ensuring that AI tools align with FERPA, COPPA, district policy, and applicable privacy and security requirements. They understand how tools collect, retain, share, and use data and promote practices that limit data collection to what is necessary for the intended purpose.

Policy and Accountability: Administrators establish clear expectations for approved tools, appropriate uses, transparency, consent, and human oversight. They help students, staff, and families understand how AI may be used, what information may be collected, and who remains responsible for decisions supported by the technology.

Incident Readiness: Administrators prepare their communities to respond when deepfakes, misinformation, harmful AI-generated content, privacy breaches, or other AI-related incidents arise. Their response reflects a commitment to safety, accurate information, timely communication, appropriate investigation, and the restoration of trust.

AI-Competent Administrator Profile: Vendor and Tool Evaluation (excerpt)

Source: web page, Profile of an AI-Competent Administrator

Administrators look beyond features and marketing claims when evaluating AI products. They consider the evidence supporting a tool, how data is used, what protections are in place, and how the system addresses cultural, racial, gender, linguistic, socioeconomic, disability-related, and other forms of bias.

AI-Competent Special Service Provider Profile: Data Synthesis and Visualization (excerpt)

Source: web page, Profile of an AI-Competent Special Service Provider

SSPs may use approved AI tools to organize, summarize, and visualize aggregated or de-identified data.

AI-Competent Special Service Provider Profile: Purposeful Tool Use (excerpt)

Source: web page, Profile of an AI-Competent Special Service Provider

SSPs select approved tools based on the professional goal, intended audience, accessibility, privacy protections, and the tool’s capabilities and limitations.

AI-Competent Special Service Provider Profile: Privacy and Ongoing Learning

Source: web page, Profile of an AI-Competent Special Service Provider

SSPs protect confidential, personally identifiable, and sensitive information and favor aggregated or de-identified data when using AI. They follow applicable legal, professional, ethical, and district requirements and continue developing their understanding of AI capabilities, limitations, risks, and evidence-informed applications as technologies and practices evolve.

Examples in Practice, AI-Competent Learner (excerpt)

Source: web page, An AI-Competent Learner: Examples in Practice

- Examines how AI data collection, resource use, and automation may affect people, communities, workers, and the environment.
- Considers whether a tool is approved and whether information is private, sensitive, or copyrighted before uploading it.
- Does not enter personal, confidential, or sensitive information into an AI system.
- Does not upload or imitate another person’s writing, image, voice, or personal information without permission.

Examples in Practice, AI-Competent Educator (excerpt)

Source: web page, An AI-Competent Educator: Examples in Practice

- Selects tools based on instructional value, student age and readiness, accessibility, privacy and security protections, approved uses, and known limitations.
- Avoids entering student records, personally identifiable information, or other sensitive information into an AI system.
- Uses AI transparently and follows applicable requirements for privacy, security, consent, copyright, licensing, attribution, and ownership.

Examples in Practice, AI-Competent Administrator: Ethical Governance and Data Stewardship

Source: web page, An AI-Competent Administrator: Examples in Practice

- Uses only AI tools and systems that comply with applicable federal and state requirements, district policies, privacy protections, security standards, and approved-use expectations.
- Understands what information an AI system collects, how long data is retained, whether information is used to train models, who may access the data, and whether information may be shared with third parties.
- Avoids entering student records, personally identifiable information, personnel information, confidential communications, or other sensitive data into AI systems unless the use is explicitly authorized and appropriately protected.
- Establishes clear expectations for which AI tools are approved, which uses are appropriate, and when disclosure, documentation, consent, or human review is required.
- Communicates with staff, students, and families about how AI is being used, what safeguards are in place, and who remains accountable for decisions.
- Develops procedures for responding to deepfakes, misinformation, impersonation, harmful AI-generated content, privacy breaches, inappropriate AI use, or other emerging incidents.
- Coordinates with technology, legal, communications, student services, human resources, and other appropriate personnel when responding to AI-related concerns.
- Reviews policies and safeguards periodically as technology, law, guidance, risks, and organizational practices evolve.

Examples in Practice, AI-Competent Administrator: Critical Evaluation and Professional Capacity (excerpt)

Source: web page, An AI-Competent Administrator: Examples in Practice

- Examines vendor claims, privacy practices, security protections, accessibility, interoperability, implementation requirements, costs, and available evidence before approving or purchasing a tool.
- Evaluates total cost of ownership, professional learning needs, technical support, vendor dependence, data portability, system interoperability, environmental considerations, and long-term sustainability before making commitments.
- Provides ongoing professional learning that helps staff understand AI capabilities, limitations, appropriate uses, privacy expectations, bias, verification, and human oversight.

Examples in Practice, AI-Competent Special Service Provider (excerpt)

Source: web page, An AI-Competent Special Service Provider: Examples in Practice

- Uses aggregated, de-identified, or synthetic information when possible and selects platforms approved for the type of information being used.
- Identifies a clear professional purpose before selecting an AI tool and uses platforms approved for the intended task and type of information involved.
- Provides relevant context, criteria, examples, audience information, and constraints when prompting AI while minimizing identifiable or confidential student information and using approved platforms when protected information is involved.

Glossary of Terms: Data Privacy and Protection

Source: web page, Glossary of Terms

Personally Identifiable Information (PII): Information that directly identifies an individual or could reasonably be combined with other information to identify them.

Sensitive Information: Information that requires heightened protection because its exposure could create risk or harm, such as health, disability, disciplinary, financial, family, legal, or confidential personnel information.

De-Identified Data: Data that has been modified to remove or obscure information that could reasonably identify an individual.

Data Minimization: The practice of collecting, using, and sharing only the information necessary for a specific educational or operational purpose.

Glossary of Terms: Legal Requirements

Source: web page, Glossary of Terms

FERPA: The Family Educational Rights and Privacy Act, a federal law that protects the privacy of student education records and gives eligible students and parents certain rights regarding those records.

COPPA: The Children’s Online Privacy Protection Act, a federal law that regulates the online collection of personal information from children under age 13.